poetry and prose that transcended borders between women writers, especially those engaged with the emerging Afro-German movement. Her book *Our Dead Behind Us* (1986), as well as a series of published and unpublished poetic fragments, journal entries, and prose essays, marked her first of multiple attempts to render the divided city as a space of critical connection, ripe for intervention.

Such individuals were not content to merely apprehend the spectacle of the Wall itself and leave; rather, they habitually revisited the relationships upholding American Cold War politics and ruminated on this line of division, over many years and multiple visits to divided Berlin. The Wall was not the sole structure on their minds in divided Berlin. They envisioned other walls of division that shadowed the practices and symbols of American freedom. Divided Berlin offered the feelings of home and haunting, a dialectic that sparked profound modes of expression and connection, as well as tensions and challenges. In each case, these figures and many others produced books and other artworks and critical discourse directed at American political divides and found ways to represent and weave in their experiences of Cold War Berlin. Thus, such treks to the Berlin Wall offered visitors a parallel site, a complex architectural doppelgänger, to weigh instances and legacies of U.S.-sponsored segregation and marginalization.

This book, *A Wall of Our Own*, traces the Berlin Wall as a site of pilgrimage for critical American cultural producers—artists, writers, and activists—who confronted the contradictions of U.S. Cold War policy and practice while in Berlin. By the Wall, these creative individuals and activists weighed the possibilities and limits of American democracy. They were sparked by their first encounters with the Wall, incorporated their reflections in books and artworks directed toward the geopolitics of division in the United States, and continued to consider divided Germany as a site of intersection of aesthetics and activism over the respective courses of their careers. Alongside historical relationships forged through military and political interactions, the American artists and writers who visited Berlin also treated the city as a place of critical and creative passage. These individuals embodied, challenged, and transformed a broader postwar occupation and cultural preoccupation with the Berlin Wall and its relationship to ingrained and emergent practices of division in the United States.